

New York Permit Test — Cheat Sheet

High-yield facts & memory hooks · verified against the official NYS manual

DRILL THESE FIRST — your common misses

- ✓ **Fire hydrant = 15 ft** (never 5/6/8)
- ✓ Dim high beams: **500 ft** oncoming · **200 ft** following
- ✓ **School zone = 15-20 mph** (NOT 25)
- ✓ **ORANGE** sign = construction (yellow = warning)
- ✓ School bus red lights = stop **20 ft, both ways**
- ✓ Following distance = **2 sec** (3-4 behind trucks)
- ✓ **NYC speed = 25** (rest of NY = 55)
- ✓ Pass on the **RIGHT** only when car ahead turns **LEFT**
- ✓ **Double solid yellow** = no pass (driveway OK)
- ✓ Return to lane with oncoming **200 ft** away
- ✓ Junior 9pm-5am: **NYC = no driving**
- ✓ Refuse chemical test = **1-yr revoke + \$500**

Key numbers

- Speed: NYC **25** · NY **55**
- School zone **15-20 mph**
- Following distance = **2 sec**
- Signal **100 ft** before a turn
- Dim high beams **500 ft** (oncoming)
- Dim high beams **200 ft** (following)
- BAC **.08** DWI · **.18** · **.02** under-21
- Report crash over **\$1,000**
- **11 points** / 18 mo → suspension

Sign shapes

- **Octagon** = STOP
- **Triangle** = YIELD
- **Pennant** = no passing
- **Pentagon** = school zone
- **Round** = railroad
- **Diamond** = warning

Passing

- Pass on the **LEFT**
- Right only if car ahead turns left
- **Double yellow** = no passing
- School bus red = stop **20 ft**

Emergencies

- Skid: **steer where you want to go**
- Brakes fail: **pump** the pedal
- Stuck gas: **shift to neutral**
- Miss exit: take the **next exit**

Parking distances

- **15 ft** — fire hydrant
- **20 ft** — crosswalk
- **30 ft** — signal / STOP sign
- **50 ft** — railroad crossing
- Uphill + curb: wheels **AWAY**
- Downhill: wheels **TOWARD** curb

Sign colors

- **Red** = stop / prohibited
- **Yellow** = warning
- **Orange** = construction
- **Blue** = services
- **Brown** = parks / historic
- **Green** = directions
- **White** = speed / rules
- **Pink** = incident

Traffic lights

- **Flashing red** = STOP sign
- **Flashing yellow** = caution
- **Steady yellow** = stop if safe
- **Dark signal** = 4-way stop

Alcohol & weather

- Only **TIME** lowers BAC
- Refuse test = **1-yr revoke**
- Fog / rain / snow = **LOW beams**
- **Bridges ice first**

NYC & junior

- NYC: **no right on red**
- NYC speed = **25 mph**
- Junior 9pm-5am: **NYC = none**
- Phone / text = **\$200 + 5 pts**